

FILM REVIEWS

WANTED

Guns & Poses

RATING ★☆☆☆☆

Director: Prabhudeva

Starring: Salman Khan,
Ayesha Takia, Prakash Raj

Short man. Big muscles. Remake of a Tamil blockbuster. Lots of blood. An armoury of dangerous instruments, ranging from cement blocks to iron bars. No, it's not *Ghajini*. It's *Wanted* and it stars Salman Khan at his working class best. "*Main khoon aur sharab apni marzi se peeta hoon*," he says, pausing for just a beat, waiting for the audience to clap and whistle. "*Sooar jhund main shikaar karta hai aur sher akela*." Pause. Again imagined applause. Prabhudeva clearly thought the premise was enough promise. Cast the man of the masses as the hero of the underclass who kills for

money but defends women and children. Do a few beautifully choreographed songs after putting your lead actors on a liquid diet for a week. And cast a veteran southern actor (here it's Prakash Raj) who can do reptilian with a flourish. That's pretty much the idea of a movie which may as well have been called *Radhey Goes to War*. There is, of course, a higher purpose to the street thug's life and it is revealed in the final orgy of flying fists and rippling muscles where for 25 minutes at a stretch Salman shows who's got the best body in Khandom. Pity about the movie.

by Kaveree Bamzai



DIL BOLE HADIPPA

Washed Out

RATING ★☆☆☆☆

Director: Anurag Singh

Starring: Rani Mukerji,
Shahid Kapoor

The problem with recently promoted assistant directors is that they feel obliged to pay obeisance to their mentors. Which is why *Dil Bole Hadippa* ends up as a hybrid of *Veer-Zaara* meets *Chak De! India* meets

Dilwale Dulhaniya Le Jayenge.

There's much waxing lyrical on *jhappiyon ka desh*, its *sarson de khet* and it's jalebi and rabdi.

There's a female empowerment speech at the end about girls being as good as boys. There's an India-Pakistan angle with old buddies Anupam Kher and Dalip Tahil heading two teams, one from Lahore and another from Amritsar. And most of all, there's a high-tension sporting finale that is meant to set your heart racing. It doesn't. Not even when Kapoor does his best Shah Rukh Khan imitation, dressed in a pink shirt, arms outstretched, mustard fields in the background. Even Mukerji as the cute Sardar boy ends up a bore. She bats straight, but without charisma. We'll stick to Sachin. -KB



EXHIBITION

Smart WEAVE

In the race towards synthetic weaves and fashion weeks, we seem to have forgotten the original weaver who was both a designer and creator. The exhibition, Kashi Kaleidoscope: Wonders of Varanasi Looms, was curated by Sribhas Supakar as a tribute to his father Jadunath Supakar, the artist and textile designer who strode the world of textile design for over 30 years. One will get a rare insight into the incredible creativity of the Varanasi weavers, who absorbed



GETHUA WOVEN TAPESTRY

various influences and evolved a unique technique but are in penury today as cheap import textiles flood the market. The exhibition includes the Jamdani, traditionally woven in Dhaka; Banarasi Fekhuan, the intricate brocading; Banarasi Kaduan, which was used as a ceiling decoration; and Gethua brocading. At Alliance Francaise De Delhi. On display till September 30. by S. Sahaya Ranjit

IF YOU HAVE 120 MINUTES, listen to Ameen Sayani talk about the development of radio and his show, *Geetmala*. At India Habitat Centre, Delhi, on October 4.